

Using My Senses: Tasting

RESOURCE TITLE:	Using My Senses: Tasting
INTENDED USER:	Small group
TEACHING PURPOSE:	Using appropriate vocabulary to describe how things taste. Students will taste items and describe them as being salty, sweet, sour or bitter.

Teaching Suggestions

Activity Preparation

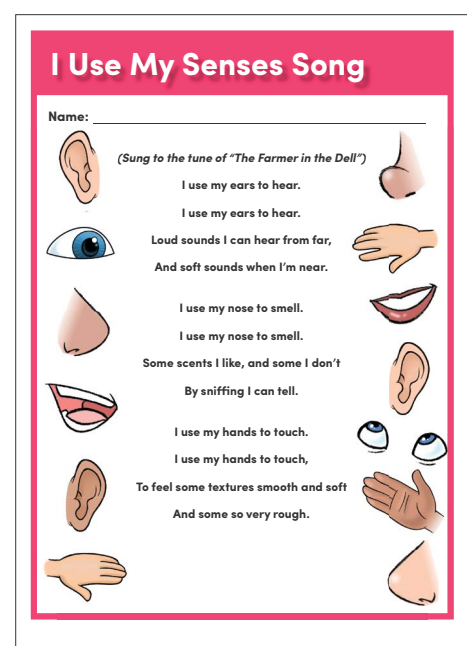
1. Photocopy "Tongue Picture Card" onto strong paper.
2. Laminate "Tongue Picture Card" for durability.
3. Make a poster of "I Use My Senses Song".
4. Fill one container halfway with sugar, and label it "Sweet", using a permanent marker. Fill a second container halfway with salt, and label it "Salty". Fill a third container halfway with unsweetened chocolate or baking soda, and label it "Bitter". Fill a fourth container halfway with lemon juice, and label it "Sour".
5. Remove the labels from some jars of baby food. Place each label upside down under its jar.
6. Before beginning the activity, be aware of any food allergies any students might have or foods that they are not allowed to eat.

Vocabulary Words

- taste
- tongue
- sweet
- salty
- bitter
- sour

Building Background

Ask the students if they know what it means if someone says, "She has a sweet tooth." Discuss how some people enjoy foods that taste sweet. Then, have the students brainstorm foods that they think are sweet. Tell the students that today they will be learning about one of our five senses – our sense of taste. Show the students the four "Taste Word Cards", and explain that our tongues not only sense sweet foods, but also salty, bitter and sour foods. Show the students the "Tongue Picture Card", and read the sentence on the card to them.



Activity Procedure

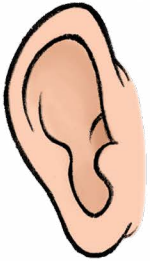
1. Gather the students around a table and show them the four labelled containers. These will be used as a reference for the students throughout the activity. Before beginning, be sure to let the students know that they should never taste unknown foods without permission from an adult that they know and trust. Also, the students will be using craft sticks or coffee stirrers as spoons to taste the different items. Therefore, it is important to model how to use the “spoons” properly and how to discard them after each taste so as not to transfer germs to others.
2. Pass out a “spoon” to the students and have them take turns dipping them into a container, tasting the item and then throwing away the “spoons”. Be sure that the students have a good foundation for understanding the differences among sweet, salty, bitter and sour tastes.
3. Teach the students the portion of the “I Use My Senses Song” that pertains to tasting.
4. Show the students the first baby food jar. Tell the students that they need to be “taste detectives” and use their sense of taste to decide whether the baby food is sweet, salty, bitter or sour. Have the students use “spoons” to taste the baby food. Then, have the group vote on which of those four basic tastes they think the baby food has. If a student has difficulty deciding, have him or her refer to the four labelled containers for support. Show the students the baby food label and discuss which basic taste it has. Repeat the procedure with the remaining jars of baby food.

Adaptations

- Let the students know that there is actually a fifth basic taste that has been identified, called umami. This basic taste is said to be synonymous with “meaty” or “savory” and has only recently been added to the list of basic tastes.
- Instead of using baby food, use various flavoured jelly beans.

I Use My Senses Song

Name: _____



(Sung to the tune of "The Farmer in the Dell")

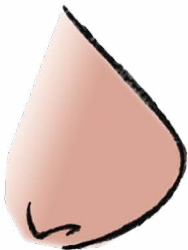
I use my ears to hear.

I use my ears to hear.



Loud sounds I can hear from far,

And soft sounds when I'm near.



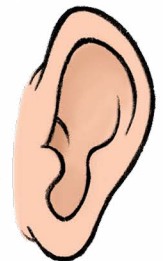
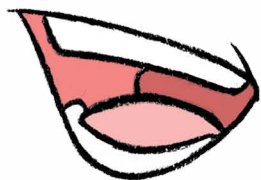
I use my nose to smell.

I use my nose to smell.



Some scents I like, and some I don't

By sniffing I can tell.

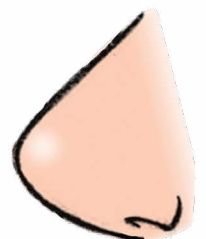
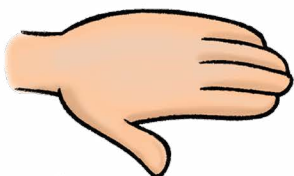
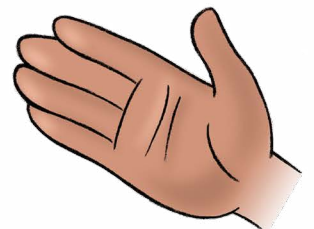


I use my hands to touch.

I use my hands to touch,

To feel some textures smooth and soft

And some so very rough.

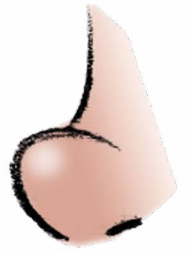
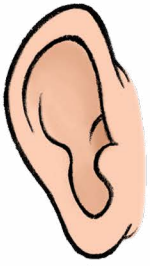


I use my tongue to taste.

I use my tongue to taste,

Salty, sour, bitter, sweet,

Each one has its place.

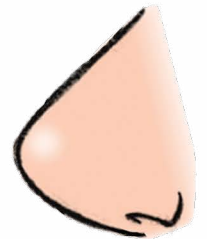
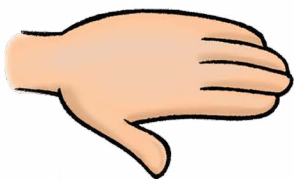
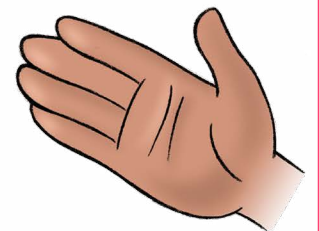
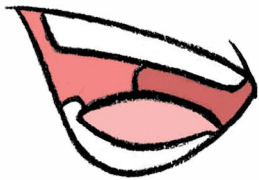
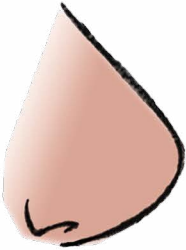


I use my eyes to see.

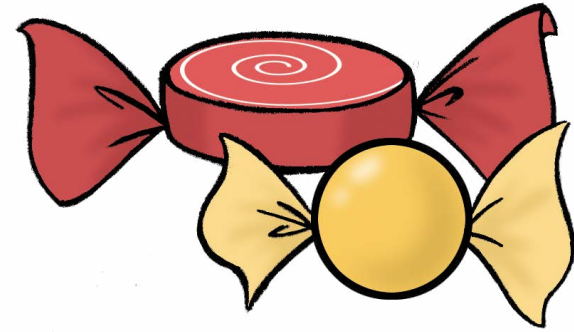
I use my eyes to see,

The colour, size and shape of things,

That are around me.



Taste Word Cards



sweet

Taste Word Cards



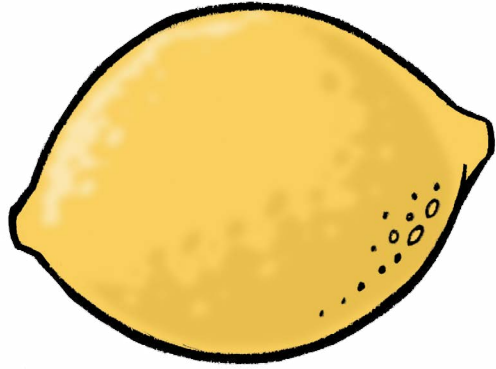
salty

Taste Word Cards



bitter

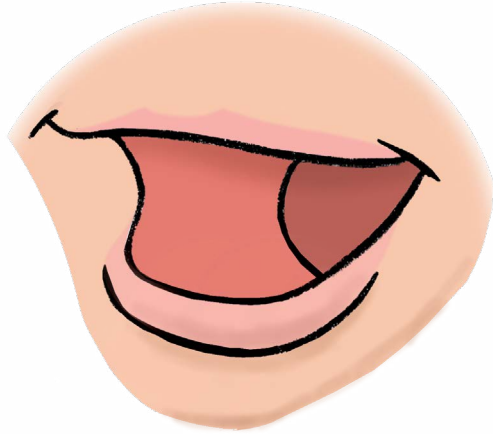
Taste Word Cards



sour



Tongue Picture Card



**I use my tongue
to taste.**

